

Project 549A-SL-506
Replace Heat Exchanger
Solicitation 36C625726R0058
Replace Heat Exchanger Bonham Questions and Answers
3/17/26

1. Specifications for units located in building #1, #2, and #29 indicate that the steam supply pressure is 15-psig. In accordance with VHA Directive 1810(1) - Operational Alert and Guidance Document FY2022-01, Cast Iron Fittings / Valve Housing Use In High and Medium Pressure Steam Distribution Systems, December 14, 2022 - "New construction, renovation, repair, replacement, or any other projects shall not use cast iron fittings, and components or malleable/ductile fittings anywhere in the high-pressure and medium pressure steam system (15 psi or above).

Answer: All new construction must use only cast steel or forged steel fittings and components, in accordance with applicable VA Master Specifications". Does this apply to the required steam work in buildings #1, #2 and #29?

2. How long is a domestic hot water outage acceptable to decommission and remove the existing Armstrong water heaters and install and commission the new water heaters?

Answer: Water cannot be turned off to inpatient facilities and to kitchen areas. Any planned water outages must be coordinated with COR and PM two weeks prior to planned outage.

3. Is the Buy-American Act included in this contract?

Answer: Please refer to clause 52.225-9 Buy American of the solicitation.

4. Are there liquidated damages?

Answer : Please refer to clause 52.211.12 of the solicitation.

5. Has hazardous material testing been completed?

Answer: No

6. Is this project tax exempt?

Answer: Please see attached V.T.C.A. Tax Code §151.311 1

7. Where are staging, laydown, and material storage areas located?

Answer: Yes, once awarded we can designate an area with COR and PM

8. Are as-built drawings or mechanical room layouts available for Buildings 1, 2, 24, and 29?

Answer: See attached drawings, the mark on the layout shows the approximate location, the marks are not too scale.

9. Can the Government provide the model and serial numbers from the existing equipment?

Answer: Yes, please coordinate with COR Felix Sanmiguel for this action.

10. Are the existing steam, condensate, and water lines confirmed to be in good condition, or should the contractor anticipate replacement of additional piping?

Answer: Due to original construction valves and regulators being replaced. Steam and water piping will require some adjustment to accommodate new installations.

11. Are specific manufacturers required for the replacement heat exchangers, or are approved equals acceptable?

Answer: Yes. Submittals will be reviewed by COR and PM

12. Can the Government confirm whether electrical power is already available near the new control valves, or must the contractor run power from an existing panel?

Answer: Yes, power is available 120V

13. Will the Government require temporary hot water systems during the replacement process?

Answer: Yes, we require it for the inpatient facilities which is the DOM and CLC. There are no connections to provide hot water to these facilities.

Are new control panels, sensors, or temperature controls required as part of the project?

Answer: Yes, and connections to the BAS system

14. Is the contractor responsible for commissioning and testing of the control valves and system operation?

Answer: Yes

15. Is hyperchlorination required for the domestic water system?

Answer: No

16. Will the contractor need to have a crane lift plan for getting equipment in and out of Building 29?

Answer: Yes

17. Will the existing equipment frames remain, or will they need to be replaced?

Answer: Yes

18. Will a copy of the sign-in sheet be provided?

Answer: Yes

19. Will the project require tying into the building's BAS system?

Answer: Yes

20. Will the VA provide a Siemens contact?

Answer: No, the awarded contractor will need to coordinate with the Architectural Engineer for this action.

21. Are all new valves required for all new heat exchangers?

Answer: Yes

22. Will any of this work have to be done overnight and or weekends?

Answer: Yes, to minimize interruptions of service to patient care areas

23. What areas do the heat exchangers feed and or what will be affected?

Answer: Domestic hot water, bathrooms, showers, kitchens

24. Will any of this work have to be phased out

Answer: Yes, coordination with the COR and PM is required.

25. What is the working psi for the lines that the Bell & Gossett pumps supply?

30psi

26. Does the VA have a specific brand of heat exchangers they are wanting to use?

No

27. In executing this project, can one superintendent fulfill the supervision, safety, and QA/QC roles?

No Safety must be a single role

28. Are contractors required to issue a contract specific QA/QC Plan?

Yes

29. Are contractors required to issue a contract specific Safety Plan?

Yes, APP plan, AHA's and JHA must be included in the APP.

30. Are shop drawings required?

Yes, all submittals/shop drawings will be reviewed by COR and PM

31. Based on field observations during the walkthrough, available height within the existing mechanical room at Building 29 may be limited for the proposed replacement configuration. Please confirm whether relocation of the new heat exchanger equipment to the first floor would be acceptable, as that area appears to provide more installation space and improved access.

No

32. Please confirm the required Siemens/BMS integration scope for the new heat exchangers. Our understanding is that the new units will be locally controlled and Siemens will monitor/report status only. Please confirm the following:

1. What points are required for monitoring?

Temperature

2. Whether BACnet communication is required?

Yes as stated above

3. Which party is responsible for final integration, programming, and checkout?

GC with QA/QC with COR and PM

33. Please confirm the circulation pump replacement requirements for each building, including quantity, basis of design, and whether all pumps associated with the existing systems are to be replaced under this contract.

All pumps are sufficiently sized in each location.

34. Please confirm whether the existing PRV assemblies are to remain in place and be reconnected, or if new PRV assemblies are required under this contract.

Yes, new valves are required.

35. What are the permitted shutdown windows for each building?

To be coordinated with COR and PM for courses of action.

36. Will evening and/or weekend work be required for all phases?

Yes, so that there is no disturbance to normal operations.

37. Are there any premium-time restrictions or specific coordination requirements that must be followed?

Yes, building 2 during operational hours. Building 24 in-patient facility requires hot water 24-7 and Building 29 kitchens and patient care requires hot water 24-7. Coordination with COR and PM will have to be conducted for possible window times.